***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q
♥ K 8 7 5
♦ A 9
♣ K Q 10 9 2

♠ J 8 7
♥ Q 3
♦ 8 6 5 2
♣ A J 8 5

♠ 10 9 6 4 3 2
♥ 4
♦ J 10 4 3
♣ 7 4

♠ A 5
♥ A J 10 9 6 2
♦ K Q 7
♣ 6 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 3♥ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♥[2] |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦5

SOUTH's 3♥ rebid shows better than average strength and six trumps.

Just what NORTH was hoping for. She bids Blackwood - her plan is to bid 7♥ if SOUTH has three Aces, bid 6♥ if he has two Aces, and stop at 5♥ if he has just one. If South has no Aces NORTH will get a new partner.

***Board 2***
South Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K J 9 7 2<br>♥ A 9 5<br>♦ Q 5<br>♣ K Q 10 | |
| ♠ 5 3<br>♥ 6 4 3<br>♦ A 10 8 6 4 3<br>♣ A 2 | | ♠ 8<br>♥ 10 8 2<br>♦ 9 7 2<br>♣ 9 8 7 6 4 3 |
| | ♠ A Q 10 6 4<br>♥ K Q J 7<br>♦ K J<br>♣ J 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 3NT |
| Pass | 4♥ | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

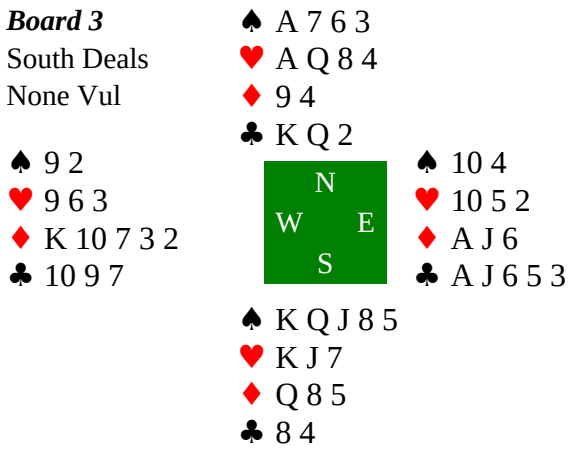
4♠ by South
Lead: ♣A

SOUTH indicates an above normal opening with five ♠s by her 3NT rebid.

NORTH also has some extra strength so he makes a Control showing bid of 4♥.

Despite both partners showing extra strength South merely signs of at 4♠. Why? Because NORTH's Control bid of 4♥ denied first-round control in both ♣s and ♦s. SOUTH realized she was off two Aces.

***Board 3***
South Deals
None Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣10

SOUTH has a minimum opening hand with no extra features to brag about. So after NORTH's Jacoby 2NT bid he merely signs off at 4♠.

NORTH would have cooperated if SOUTH had made a slam try, but she doesn't have enough to initiate the investigation herself.

***Board 4***
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ A 7 6 5
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ K Q 7 5
♣ 4

♠ K 10 9
♥ 9 6
♦ J 8 2
♣ 10 8 6 3 2

♠ J 3 2
♥ 5 3
♦ A 10 9 6 3
♣ A Q 7

♠ Q 8 4
♥ A K 8 4 2
♦ 4
♣ K J 9 5

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♥ by South
Lead: ♦2

NORTH's 4♣ is a Splinter bid. He promises 13+ points, at least four ♥s and a singleton or void in ♣s.

SOUTH is obviously forced to game, but she is not thrilled to hear about NORTH's ♣ shortness. In fact, it does nothing to help the value of her hand. So she bids the ♥ game.

***Board 5***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 7 5
♥ K 6
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ J 8 3

♠ 2
♥ 9 5 3 2
♦ A 10 7 6
♣ 10 6 4 2

♠ 10 3
♥ A 10 8 4
♦ 5 4 3
♣ A 9 7 5

♠ A Q 9 8 6 4
♥ Q J 7
♦ J 2
♣ K Q

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 3♠ |
| Pass | 4♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

SOUTH bids 3♠ to show the 6-card suit plus some extra strength.

NORTH's failure to make a Control bid in either ♣s, ♦s or ♥s, means just one thing - She doesn't have any controls.

So SOUTH settles for game.